

Final Project Rubric & Instructor Checklist

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Rubric Breakdown (100 points)

Category	Weight	Criteria
Question & Relevance	10 pts	Is the question causal? Clearly motivated?
DAG & Identification	20 pts	DAG correct & justified, assumptions transparent, adjustment sets valid
Methodology	20 pts	Appropriate causal method chosen, correctly implemented, diagnostics included
Sensitivity & Robustness	15 pts	At least one sensitivity analysis, well-explained
Results & Interpretation	15 pts	Estimates clearly reported, assumptions tied to conclusions, limitations addressed
Writing & Presentation	20 pts	Paper clarity, organization, reproducibility (R code provided), presentation quality

Instructor Checklist

Proposal (Week 9)

- ☐ Causal question is precise and relevant

- ☐ Target trial framework specified
- ☐ Preliminary DAG provided
- ☐ Identification assumptions stated

Final Paper

- ☐ Title & abstract present research clearly
- ☐ Introduction frames question causally
- ☐ DAG correct and explained
- ☐ Assumptions (exchangeability, positivity, consistency) explicitly justified
- ☐ Identification strategy appropriate
- ☐ Correct causal method implemented
- ☐ Diagnostics shown (balance, overlap, IV strength, etc.)
- ☐ Sensitivity analysis included
- ☐ Results reported with CIs and interpretation
- ☐ Discussion connects assumptions to real-world plausibility
- ☐ Annotated R code in appendix

Presentation (Week 14)

- ☐ Clear articulation of causal question & assumptions
- ☐ DAG presented visually
- ☐ Results summarized without excessive technical detail

- ☐ Interpretation emphasized over mechanics